

SpringMVC <form:form> Tag

<http://docs.spring.io/spring/docs/3.2.x/spring-framework-reference/htmlsingle/#spring-form.tld.form>

Difference between modelAttribute and commandName

Table H.4. Attributes

Attribute	Required?	Runtime Expression?	Description
commandName	false	true	Name of the model attribute under which the form object is exposed. Defaults to 'command'.
modelAttribute	false	true	Name of the model attribute under which the form object is exposed. Defaults to 'command'.

What is the difference between using commandName and modelAttribute when sending form data?

```
<form:form method="post" modelAttribute="trade">
```

and

```
<form:form method="post" commandName="trade">
```

At which point of time should I use either of them?

Answer:

There is no difference. Two different attributes exist for historical reasons.

If `modelAttribute` and `commandName` are not provided, it uses default 'command' value. In that case. The controller needs to wire:

```
@ModelAttribute("model") Map<String, Object> model
```

```
@RequestMapping(value = "/Portfolio", method = RequestMethod.GET)
public ModelAndView handleRequest(@ModelAttribute("model") Map<String, Object>
model) {
    LOG.info("Entering function.");

    return new ModelAndView("Portfolio", "command", model);
}
```